

Build Your AI Second Brain with Claude + Obsidian

This is the exact setup I use to give Claude full context on my life, so it actually knows my work, goals, projects and everything else without me re-explaining myself every time. The whole thing takes about 15 minutes.

The setup in 3 steps

1. Get Claude for desktop and open Cowork mode. Make a fresh empty folder somewhere on your computer and point Claude at it. From now on that folder is its long term memory, a second brain that lives on your machine instead of vanishing when the chat ends.
2. Paste in the prompt below. Claude interviews you about the important parts of your life, then writes it all up as clean notes with an index that tells it which note to open for any question. That index is the whole trick. It means Claude lands on the right context instantly instead of digging around or guessing.
3. Set up auto updating (Update protocol file) so Claude keeps the notes current by itself whenever something changes. Then open the same folder as a vault in Obsidian. Now you can read and edit everything by hand and you get a nice graph that shows how all your context links together.

The prompt (copy paste this into Claude)

I want you to build a personal context system that holds all the important parts of my life, so you always know the right background for anything I ask.

Step 1. Set up the structure. Create a folder with one top level subfolder for each major area of my life. Start with these and adjust based on my answers: Work/Career, Projects, Finances, Health, Learning, Personal/Relationships and Goals. If an area is complex give it its own subfolders, for example one subfolder per project.

Step 2. Interview me. Before you fill anything in, ask me plenty of questions to gather the real detail for each area, a few at a time so it never gets overwhelming. Use what you already know about me but do not assume. Keep going until you have enough to fill every file out properly.

Step 3. Build the files. Turn my answers into clean, organized markdown files, one topic per file, written so a future version of you could read them and instantly understand my situation. As you write each file, finish it with a short "Related" section that links to its related notes using Obsidian wiki links like `[[note-name]]` (the exact file name, without .md). Add these links the moment

you create each file, not as a separate pass at the end, so the vault is connected from the start.

Step 4. Create the index and the entry point. Make an [INDEX.md](#) at the top that works as a routing table, so for any kind of question I might ask it says exactly which file or files you should open. Then create a [CLAUDE.md](#) in the same folder that tells every future session to read [INDEX.md](#) first and only open the files it points to. This is what makes the system actually work later, because a fresh session reads [CLAUDE.md](#) on its own and gets routed from there.

Step 5. Keep it current. Create an UPDATE_ [PROTOCOL.md](#) file that holds the rules for keeping everything up to date, and point [CLAUDE.md](#) at it so every future session follows it. The rules: whenever something new comes up in our conversations, a number changes, a project ends, a goal appears, rewrite the relevant file in place, update its last updated date and tell me in one line what you changed. Never store the same fact in two places, cross reference instead.

Step 6. Make INDEX the graph hub. Each note already links its related notes from Step 3, so finish the graph by making INDEX link to every note in the system. Always use `[[ ]]` wiki links, never plain markdown paths, because Obsidian only draws graph connections from wiki links. The result: when I open the folder as a vault it shows a clean connected graph with INDEX at the center, not scattered dots.

First set up the folder structure, then start interviewing me. If anything is unclear, ask before you begin.

—End of prompt—

A few tips

- Be honest and detailed in the interview. The output is only as good as what you put in.
- Start with the areas that matter most (work, projects, goals) and let it grow over time.
- Pop back into Obsidian every now and then to tidy things up and enjoy the graph view.

That's it. Do this once and the quality of every single Claude session goes up.

I hope this helps. As always, feel free to reach out if you have any questions.